

TIMOTHY MEYER

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

International Economics, Macroeconomics, Political Economy

REFERENCES

Moritz Schularick

Kiel Institute for the World Economy
president@ifw-kiel.de

Farzad Saidi

University of Bonn
saidi@uni-bonn.de

Christoph Trebesch

Kiel Institute for the World Economy
christoph.trebesch@ifw-kiel.de

EDUCATION

PhD Candidate, Bonn Graduate School of Economics

2020 - present

Visiting PhD student, University of California Berkeley

01/2025–05/2025

invited by Prof. Jón Steinsson

Visiting PhD student, Global Capital Allocation Lab at Stanford GSB

05/2025

invited by Prof. Matteo Maggiori

Visiting PhD student, University of California Berkeley

2021 - 2022

Bachelor of Science in Economics, University of Bonn

2017 - 2020

Bachelor of Science in Mathematics, University of Bonn

2016 - 2020

RESEARCH AND WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Associate

2023-present

Kiel Institute for the World Economy

Research Assistant

2022

Prof. Pierre-Olivier Gourinchas, University of California Berkeley

Work on CIP deviations and monetary policy

Research Assistant

2019 - 2020

Prof. Moritz Schularick, University of Bonn

Work on house prices, savings gluts and wealth inequality

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Best Paper Award, 23rd RIEF Doctoral Meeting

2024

Doctoral Scholarship, Bonn Graduate School of Economics

2020-2023

German National Merit Foundation (Studienstiftung)

2016 - 2022

JOB MARKET PAPER

Hegemonic Competition with Carrots and Sticks

(with Nicolas Wesseler)

Hegemonic powers use economic threats and payments to influence the geopolitical alignment of third countries. We develop a bargaining model in which two competing hegemonies use direct payments (*carrots*) and economic threats (*sticks*) to influence third countries. To quantify the model, we combine historical data on U.S. and Soviet aid to non-aligned countries during the Cold War with a model of international trade. We provide causal evidence on the impact of carrots and sticks on geopolitical alignment. Consistent with the model, there is a hump-shape between carrots and sticks in the data. Applying our findings to the U.S.-China geopolitical competition, we find that China largely decreases its foreign aid in response to a USAID shutdown.

PUBLICATIONS

Asset Price Changes, External Wealth and Global Welfare

Journal of International Economics, Volume 157, September 2025

U.S. equity outperformance and sustained dollar appreciation have led to large valuation gains for the rest of the world on the U.S. external position. I construct their global distribution, carefully accounting for the role of tax havens. Valuation gains are concentrated and large in developed countries, while developing countries have been mostly bypassed. To assess the welfare implications of these capital gains, I adopt a sufficient statistics approach. In contrast to the large wealth changes, most countries so far did not benefit much in welfare terms. This is because they did not rebalance their portfolios and realize their gains. In contrast, direct welfare effects from the dollar appreciation on import and export prices are an order of magnitude larger.

RESEARCH

The Wealth of Generations

(with Luis Bauluz)

Revise and Resubmit, Review of Economic Studies

This paper provides the first systematic evidence on life-cycle wealth accumulation across birth cohorts. Using historical U.S. microdata dating back to 1960, we document two shifts in life-cycle dynamics beginning in the 1980s. Relative to their lifetime incomes, recent cohorts accumulate substantially more wealth. They also save more during middle age and have become large dissavers in old age, accounting for the stagnation of the U.S. saving rate. We link this transformation to the post-1980s boom in asset prices and examine its implications for age-wealth inequality and intergenerational welfare. A stylized OLG model reconciles our cohort-level findings with macroeconomic trends.

The Great Leveler According to HANK

(with Ralph Luetticke, Gernot Müller and Moritz Schularick)

Using historical data on income and wealth, we establish systematic patterns showing that war significantly reduces inequality. War persistently reduces the top-1% income share by 30% and the top-1% wealth share by 10%. It also destroys capital, reducing the capital-income share by approximately 25%. All else equal, the decline in the capital share explains, at most, half of the drop in the top income share. Therefore, we develop a Heterogeneous Agent New Keynesian (HANK) model, which endogenizes the decline in the capital share, incorporates multiple sources of capital income, and can match the empirical decline in inequality.

The Emerging Market Great Moderation

(with Alfredo Mendoza-Fernandez)

We document a Great Moderation in emerging markets, a dramatic fall in aggregate macroeconomic volatility by about 40%, without changes in other distinctive characteristics of emerging market business

cycles. Using a novel methodology, we link the moderation to canonical emerging market business cycle theories. Consistent with those theories, the contribution of fluctuations in the growth trend is substantial, and has not diminished. The moderation resulted in important welfare gains in emerging economies and stems from a reduction in country-specific volatility, which can be linked to shifts in monetary policy.

PRESENTATIONS AND SUMMER SCHOOLS

2025: 3rd ASB-CEPR-ERSA-ADB-CAMA-BNM Workshop on Macroeconomic Policy in Emerging Markets, Berkeley Macro Student-Faculty Seminar, Bay Area Economic History Workshop

2024: ifo Dresden Workshop on Macroeconomics and International Finance, RIEF Doctoral Meeting, 3rd Kiel-CEPR Conference on Geoeconomics*

2023: RGS Doctoral Conference in Economics, NBER Summer Institute*, European Central Bank, DIW workshop 'Unveiling Wealth and Income Inequalities'

2022: Berkeley Macro Student-Faculty seminar, Bonn Macro Lunch Seminar

*: *Presented by co-author*

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

1st Summer School in International Economy by the Journal of International Economics	2023
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Stanford Big Data Initiative in International Macro-Finance	2023
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NBER Heterogeneous-Agent Macro Workshop	2022
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TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant for Empirical Macroeconomics, Ph.D., Kiel Institute, 2025

Teaching Assistant, Mathematics Preparatory Course, University of Bonn, 2017

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Kiel-CEPR Research Seminar, Co-Organizer	2024–
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Fellowships at Kiel Institute for the World Economy, Co-Organizer	2024–
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Berlin-Bonn Macro Workshop, Co-Organizer	2024
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Bonn Macro reading group, Co-organizer	2021-2024
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MEDIA COVERAGE

Bloomberg: Young Americans Seen Failing to Match Baby Boomers' Wealth Gains

El Confidencial: ¿Por qué a los jóvenes les va peor que a los mayores? Nacieron demasiado tarde

Economist: Inheriting is becoming nearly as important as working

PERSONAL

Citizenship: Germany, USA

Languages: German (native), English (native), Spanish (good)

Programming: Matlab, R, Stata, Python

Updated: September, 2025